

Double consonants and suffixes

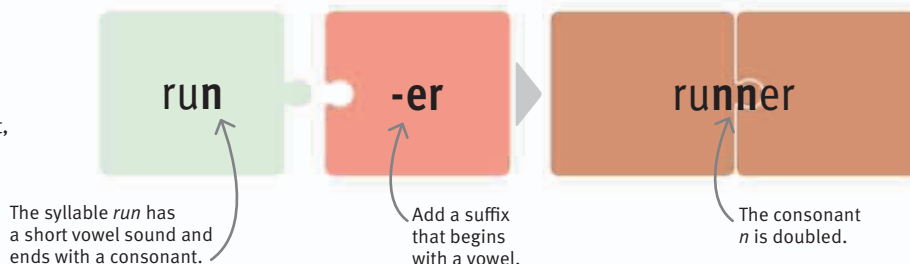
Consonants that come at the end of a word are often doubled when a suffix is added. This mostly applies to verbs. For example, the final consonant of the verb *sit* is doubled after adding the suffix -ing, which results in the word *sitting*.



• Consonants are **doubled** when adding a **prefix** or **another word** that ends with the same letter as the first letter of the root. For example, the prefix **mis-** and root **spell** combine to make **misspell**.

▷ Rule 1

When adding a suffix that begins with a vowel, such as -er, to a verb that has one syllable and ends with a short vowel sound and a consonant, the final consonant is often doubled.



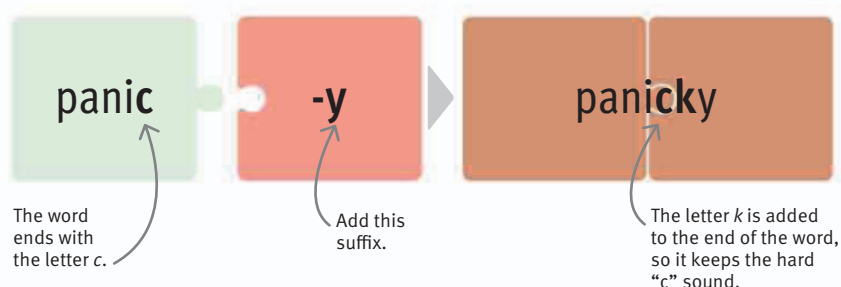
▷ Rule 2

When adding a suffix that begins with a vowel, such as -ing, to a verb with more than one syllable, which ends with a short vowel sound and a consonant, the final consonant is usually doubled.



▷ Rule 3

When adding a suffix that begins with *e*, *i*, or *y* to a verb that ends in *c*, the final consonant is not doubled. Instead, the letter *k* is added after *c* in order to keep the hard “c” sound.



GLOSSARY

Consonant A letter of the alphabet that is not a vowel.

Prefix A group of letters attached to the start of a word that can change the original word's meaning.

Suffix A group of letters attached to the end of a word that can change the original word's meaning.

Syllable A unit of pronunciation that has one vowel sound.

Vowel One of the five letters *a*, *e*, *i*, *o*, and *u*.

In English, **bookkeeper** and **bookkeeping** are the only words with **three consecutive double letters**.